

storage of solar energy beyond daylight hours will be critical to its emergence as a mainstream source of power. In the meantime, we may need to explore hybrid solutions, combining solar power generation with gas, biomass or even coal-based power," said Dr Singh.

Cabinet clears revised ICT scheme for schools

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs has approved a revised scheme of information and communication technology (ICT) for schools that will benefit students in government and government-aided secondary and higher secondary schools in the country. The revised scheme would enable teachers and students to get acquainted with the ICT system.

The scheme aims at capacity building of more than one million teachers in using ICT-based tools for teaching through induction and refresher training. The schools would be provided the required computer hardware, software and e-content for the purpose. Dependable power supply and Internet connectivity, preferably broadband, would be provided to the schools.

UID to create the world's largest biometric database

The Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) is planning to collate personal information of Indian citizens to create the world's largest biometric database. Plans are afoot to use as many as three unique identification features while allotting a personalised identity number to every resident in the country. The UIDAI will use iris scans, face scans and all ten fingerprints together to minimise any system error that might creep in during the registration process.

The UIDAI expects to collect data of approx. 600 million people in the next four-five years with an accuracy rate of about 95 per cent. The database is likely to be used by central and state government agencies, and private organisations, such as banks and insurance companies.

Soota receives Golden Peacock Award

Ashok Soota, co-founder and executive chairman, MindTree, has been conferred the *Golden Peacock Award for Technology Leadership 2010* for his outstanding achievements and leadership qualities. The award, instituted by the Institute of Directors (IOD), was given away at the *IOD Convention 2010* held in Bengaluru.

Seagate projects positive outlook for storage industry

Seagate looks forward to a very positive 2010 riding on revival of economies in the Asia Pacific region, especially India and China. The company had achieved shipment volume of one billion drives in 2008 and expects to achieve the next one billion within the next five years, riding on the back of explosive requirement for storage both at enterprise and consumer levels.

The company expects the growing digital lifestyles and exploding enterprise data to drive growth of the storage industry. Asia-Pacific and Japan contribute almost half of the company's revenue.

Samsung launches new digicams and camcorders

Samsung India has launched its 2010 digital imaging (digital camera and camcorder) lineup in India. The new digital camera range has models across the ES, PL, ST and WB series. The company has also for the first time showcased its portable NX10 hybrid digital camera model. In the camcorder segment, it has launched new models across its K, H and F series.

With the addition of these new models, Samsung digital cameras range comprises a total of 30 models priced between Rs 7990 and Rs 24,990. The Samsung digital camcorder range now has a total of eleven models, including the seven new launches, which are priced between Rs 16,990 and Rs 45,990.

Canon eyes revenue of Rs 11 billion

Canon India, which recently slipped to third position in the digital camera category, has announced its aggressive

strategy for this year. The company plans to invest Rs 550 million in the marketing of the camera business. It is also announcing new campaigns such as 'Canon on Wheels' and 'My IXUS, My Style' to tap a wider audience and reposition the category this year.

"Camera industry is growing at the rate of 35 per cent per annum in India and Canon wants to replicate its success stories of the world in India too. Canon is rolling out aggressive marketing plans to touch Rs 4.5-billion revenue in camera division out of a total of Rs 11 billion in 2010," said Kensaku Konishi, president and chief executive officer, Canon India.

NEC introduces unified communication solutions

NEC India has reiterated its plans to increase its focus on the hospitality sector, with launch of the Univerge SV8500—an enterprise communication solution that can offer a secure platform for customers who wish to unify their business communications. The company also recently entered into strategic alliances with several system integrator partners to offer solutions for education and hospitality verticals.

The Univerge SV8500 can support up to 16,000 endpoints in a single system. Scalable and energy-efficient, it is an advanced application server that supports voice, unified communications and mobility solutions for tens of thousands of users in a networked environment.

LSI expands India R&D Base

To house more VLSI chip engineers, LSI has expanded its R&D centre in Pune. The company has doubled its capacity to broaden the scope of